Meta Hands-on Project : Exploring Placemaking for Rest and Healing in the Metaverse: Designing VR Social Spaces for Addressing and Coping with Negative Experiences

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Abstract

Compared with reducing the harassment that might happen in Metaverse, providing a rest and healing place for those who had negative experiences is not focused enough. In this project, we are trying to approach the kinds of objects that can be made in order to provide the sense of relaxation for the general public based on small sets of autoethnographic reflection data, and we are trying to explore the combination between emotions and placemaking, as well as virtual versus reality.

Introduction

Nowadays, VR technology is developing rapidly, but it has some negative effects. People cannot get rest in the metaverse, resulting in the only way to rest is to exit the metaverse. In order to solve these problems, resting places are created in VR space. First, placemaking will be introduced. Placemaking is a community-oriented way of re-creating public spaces that provide services to the community. Secondly, an example of placemaking healing people will be presented. Genshin is currently very popular among young people. In genshin, there are not only various characters, wild monsters, and NPCs, but also many beautiful scenes to explore and discover. In the course of the game, players have to complete quests and challenge wild monsters again and again, which usually makes them feel very exhausted. But the beautiful scenery can let the player relax after the intense fight, so that the irritable mood can calm down.

Methods

- Autoethnographic Reflection

The dataset of this project is in the form of small sets of autoethnographic reflections, that is, the records of experiences of the communities while exploring the rest and healing place in the metaverse. Improvements on placemaking are made based on this dataset.

- Ichnography

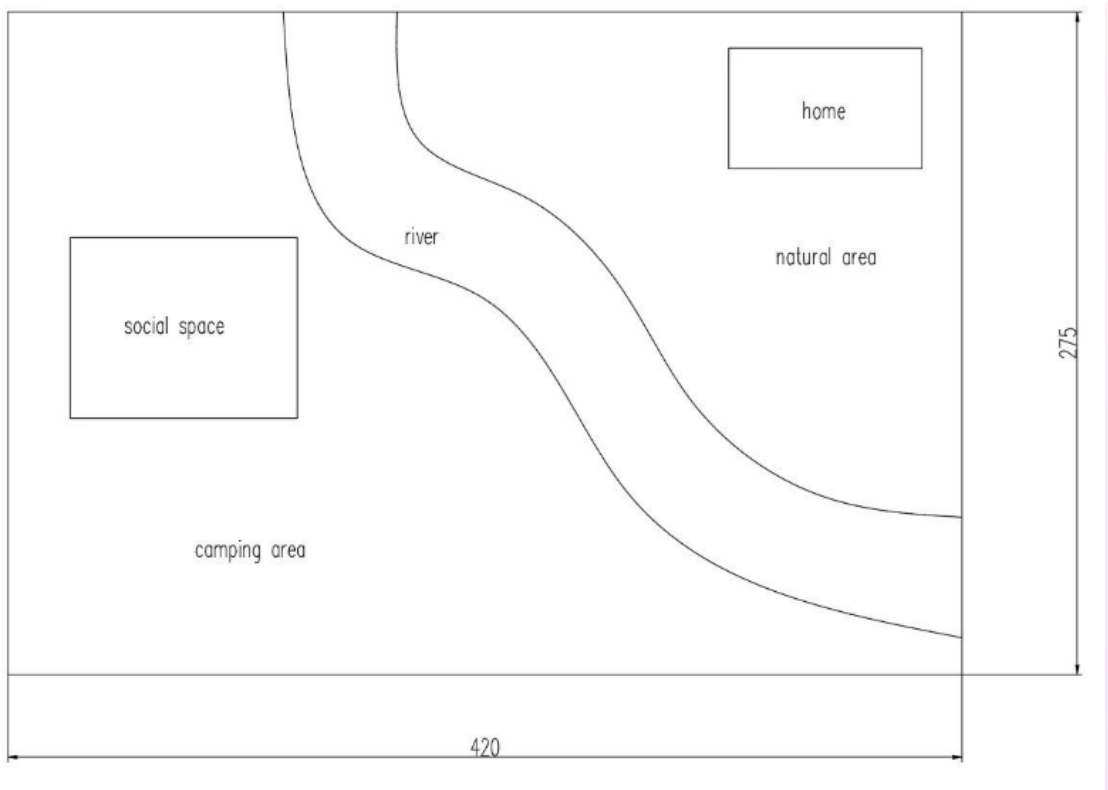
Ichnography is plotted, which is aiming to determine the major elements to be included, and plan for the approximated sizes of each area.

- 3D Modelling

Several 3D modelling tools are used for rendering the space based on their features. Specifically, large terrains like mountains are created in unity; Indoor details, for example, furniture are made by sketchup. Finally, all elements are combined in a single space, and the whole space is presented through Arkio.

Results and discussion

In order to include as much diversity of the public as possible, we divided the site we made into 3 parts: individual zone, separation and connection, and social zone, which is illustrated in the following ichnography.



Ichnography plan for the entire space

Part I Individual zone

- The individual zone contains the natural scenes and our home, so that the group of people who prefer to stay alone to relax can fully enjoy themselves here. The major terrain included here is a pink mountain. Because we all like ice cream, which we believe can bring happiness when the frustrating emotion comes up, we made the mountain into pink ice cream.
- According to our previous VR game experience, we want to build a warm and multi-functional home with a variety of entertainment methods that can completely relax.
- The home building has a wooden structure and texture. In architectural design, wood is the most humane material. In the place of a natural scene, we believe it is better than a modern apartment. However, the utilities are not less than what is included in a nice apartment - we have bedroom, washroom, activity room, balcony, and even a room for stargazing.

The softer ice cream mountain surrounding our home

- Although we have planned for a social zone and individual zone, we are not limiting the possibility to invite friends to the individual zone for the fun activities. In the activity room, we have a mahjong table and a foosball table. In our culture, these are common games for family and friends to play at home.

Activity room

- For us, looking up to the sky at night is a good way of thinking. Instead of standing on the balcony, we can lie down and look through the attic window on the third floor's stargazing room. At the same time, we can read and drink here.

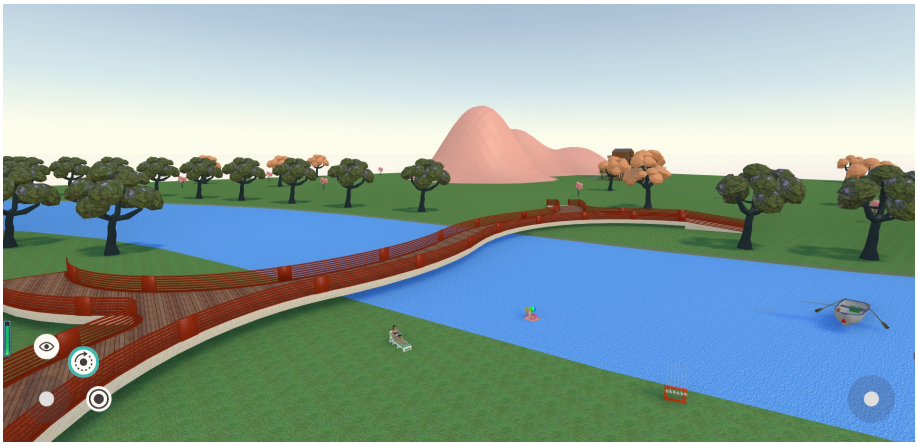
We can lie down on the carpet and enjoy the night view

- Nevertheless, a hot spring is usually a good choice for vacation, we also have a hot spring in our backyard. Through the open-air hot spring in a pleasant environment, we can completely relax physically and mentally.

Hot spring

Part II Separation and Connection

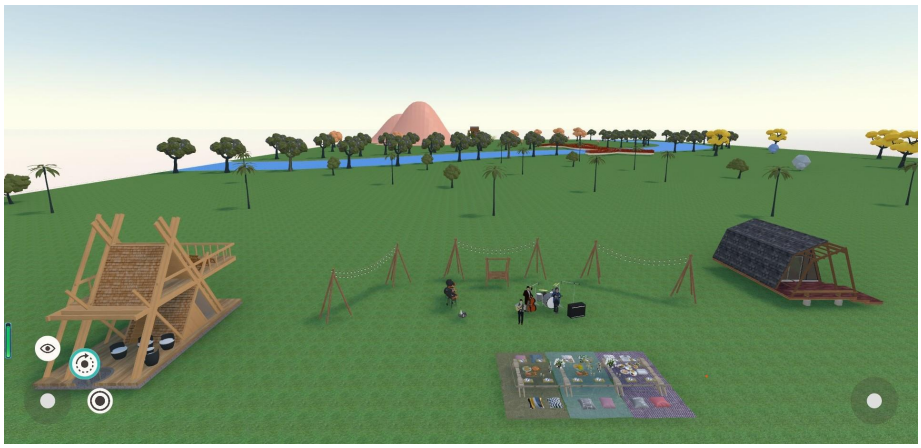
- The individual zone and social zone is separated by a river. It is not only a boundary, it can also provide functions like fishing and swimming.
- Since we do not want to strictly separate the two zones, and to give the ownership to all space, we built a bridge on the river to connect the two zones. And we think it is a good sign of building connections with others.



The bridge

Part III Social Zone

- Within this social zone, we can hang out with our friends or make new friends. There are different kinds of camping houses to choose from. Besides food and music are always good transmitters for communication. We can share our stories during a meal, and interact with each other on this open land.



We can play and eat and enjoy

Conclusions and prospects

In this project, we built a kind of mapping between virtual and reality. Our placemaking is a good combination of public and individual, including public space and individual space, public

needs and individual needs. In this situation, people can make friends, have fun with others, relax and rest. In a word, through the mapping of virtual and reality, the combination of public and individual, the fusion of nature and humanity, we have created a friendly interactive space or community .

In the future, We hope our work or model can be lighter, quicker and cheaper. And the details are as follows.

(1) **Lighter:** Smaller, shorter term experiments and improvements.
(2) **Quicker:** Our work requires quicker iterations.
(3) **Cheaper:** Less cost in terms of money, time, labor, resources, etc.

We are looking forward to exploring more possibilities in the metaverse, reality-based or beyond reality. And we are never finished!